

On Windows

You can use the terminal command `cd`, for *change directory*, to navigate through your filesystem in a command window. The command `dir`, for *directory*, shows you all the files that exist in the current directory.

Open a new terminal window and enter the following commands to run `hello_world.py`:

```
C:\> cd Desktop\python_work
C:\Desktop\python_work> dir
hello_world.py
C:\Desktop\python_work> python hello_world.py
Hello Python world!
```

First, use the `cd` command to navigate to the `python_work` folder, which is in the `Desktop` folder. Next, use the `dir` command to make sure `hello_world.py` is in this folder. Then run the file using the command `python hello_world.py`.

Most of your programs will run fine directly from your editor. However, as your work becomes more complex, you'll want to run some of your programs from a terminal.

On macOS and Linux

Running a Python program from a terminal session is the same on Linux and macOS. You can use the terminal command `cd`, for *change directory*, to navigate through your filesystem in a terminal session. The command `ls`, for *list*, shows you all the nonhidden files that exist in the current directory.

Open a new terminal window and enter the following commands to run `hello_world.py`:

```
~$ cd Desktop/python_work/
~/Desktop/python_work$ ls
hello_world.py
~/Desktop/python_work$ python3 hello_world.py
Hello Python world!
```

First, use the `cd` command to navigate to the `python_work` folder, which is in the `Desktop` folder. Next, use the `ls` command to make sure `hello_world.py` is in this folder. Then run the file using the command `python3 hello_world.py`.

Most of your programs will run fine directly from your editor. But as your work becomes more complex, you'll want to run some of your programs from a terminal.